In This Issue

As the hard-working *AHR* staff has reminded me more than once, the June issue contains a record number of individual pieces in the articles section: our inaugural "History Unclassified" essay, thirteen short reflections on the events and memory of "1968," an *AHR* Forum with four separate contributions, a reappraisal of historical anthropologist Eric Wolf's *Europe and the People without History*, and three special reviews of recent volumes in the *Foreign Relations of the United States* documentary series published by the U.S. State Department's Office of the Historian. I think that makes twenty-two; getting these all ready for publication on time represents a heroic effort on everyone's part.

The issue opens with our first contribution to a new feature, "History Unclassified." With **Kate Brown** (University of Maryland, Baltimore County) serving as consulting editor, the *AHR* intends to publish essays that approach the past in a different voice than is usually found in our pages. Playing with narrative format and wedding methodological innovation to self-conscious reflections about the uncertainties of historical research, "History Unclassified" is designed to throw open the journal to new ideas about what it means to be a historian. Here we begin with "Cities, Time, and the Backward Glance," a personal meditation by **Taymiya R. Zaman** (University of San Francisco) on her entanglement with the Mughal past as a Muslim, a scholar, a Pakistani, a Westerner, and a woman.

Zaman's essay is followed by another experiment, this one focused on the fiftieth anniversary of the events of 1968. In February and April 2009, the *AHR* ran a two-part forum on the history of "The International 1968." The political and cultural epoch of "1968" was, above all, about breaking the established rules—whether those rules came from an older generation, from inadequate democratic processes, from capitalist diktats, or from sclerotic socialist or revolutionary regimes. Our effort in this issue to commemorate 1968—appearing under the heading "*AHR* Reflections"—breaks a few rules of its own. First, there is the format, with which we took editorial license. When commissioning these thirteen very short essays, I explicitly asked contributors to eschew scholarly discourse in favor of reflective interventions examining the legacy and meaning of 1968 from the distance of fifty years. That loose format and deliberately vague charge produced some traditional academic prose, but also generated some personal contemplation, as well as an emphasis on the shifting meanings of 1968 over time—as

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more than one scholar has observed, the half-century mark is the twilight moment at which living memory begins to shade into archival-based history.

In addition to this unusual format, the essays create an unorthodox social geography of 1968. Yes, Prague and Paris and West Berlin, but also Warsaw and Turin and East Berlin. Not London, but Belfast. Mexico City, of course, but places with less exact timing: China, Africa, the Arab world. Canada. Not Columbia University, but the U.S. Left Coast, and the emergence there of Third-Worldism and revolutionary black nationalism. The burgeoning historiography of the "global sixties" has yet to settle on a comparative or transnational explanatory framework: Did events happen in synchronicity in 1968 because distinctive societies underwent similar experiences of modernity and generational discontent, or were these local explosions set off by sparks leaping from place to place? Was 1968 a "moment" or, as one of our contributors puts it, a synecdoche for a whole host of decade-long transformations? It depends where one stands, and readers may be inspired to develop their own East-West, North-South, and even South-South comparisons. While these collective reflections cannot offer a definitive answer to such questions, the intention is that they will scatter many seeds for further contemplation and research.

The reflections on 1968 are followed by a more typical feature, one of our serendipitous *AHR* Forums, assembled from three articles submitted under separate cover. This one, "Vernacular Ways of Knowing," showcases methodological innovations that can provide new insights into aspects of the past often regarded as largely unknowable. As Mesoamericanist **Camilla Townsend** (Rutgers University) notes in her introduction to the forum, all three articles, with their common emphasis on language—both oral and written—return us to the original meaning of the vernacular, namely the power of the mother tongue as an antidote against linguistic traditions imposed by others.

In the opening article in the forum, "Bereft, Selfish, and Hungry: Greater Luhyia Concepts of the Poor in Precolonial East Africa," **Rhiannon Stephens** (Columbia University) uses historical linguistics to reconstruct conceptualizations of poverty in precolonial East Africa. Her article explores how people speaking Greater Luhyia languages redefined what it meant to be poor as they settled new lands and interacted with other communities over time. Views of poverty in this region gradually evolved from indicating the economic vulnerability associated with bereavement to being linked with personal selfishness and deceit. Through an analysis of the shifting landscape of language, Stephens highlights the dynamism in Greater Luhyian economic thought, tracing linguistic and thus conceptual change well before the advent of colonialism, Christianity, and capitalism in Africa.

James Pickett (University of Pittsburgh) similarly recuperates lost voices in "Written into Submission: Reassessing Sovereignty through a Forgotten Eurasian Dynasty." As he notes, the Central Asian city of Shahrisabz (in present-day Uzbekistan) has remained little more than a historical footnote, regarded merely as a thorn in the side of its more powerful neighbors during the seventeenth through the late nineteenth centuries. In

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fact, Pickett shows, Shahrisabz was an autonomous city-state in its own right. The obfuscation of this city's past reveals much about historical methodology and premodern logics of sovereignty. To recover Shahrisabz's story, Pickett revisits Persian texts that dominate historical knowledge of this region, piecing together scattered fragments composed within the city itself. In doing so, he illustrates how seemingly contradictory forms of sovereignty coexisted within a single polity. In Pickett's account, approaches to sources and concepts of sovereignty are intertwined, with insights into the latter possible only with careful attention to the language and logics embedded in the former.

Finally, in "The Waves of Heterotopia: Toward a Vernacular Intellectual History of the Indian Ocean," **Nile Green** (UCLA) focuses on this polyglot region's diverse vernacular spheres of writing that rapidly widened in the era of print. Green contends that the characterization of the colonial-era Indian Ocean as an arena of "cosmopolitanism" proves a poor fit with the variety of intellectual transactions evident across so heterogeneous a space. By widening his conceptual apparatus across a multiplicity of print traditions, Green challenges the premise that oceanic actors operated under the intellectual hegemony of a "colonial episteme." Overall, his essay argues for understanding the nineteenth-century Indian Ocean through alternative conceptual frameworks of "vernacularism" and "heterotopia" that allow for the multiple intellectual trajectories of such world-historical contact zones.

The June issue also contains another entry in our ongoing "*AHR* Reappraisal" series, one that is relevant to the concerns of the forum. In "Crooked Lines of Relevance," **Pekka Hämäläinen** (University of Oxford) offers a reconsideration of Marxist anthropologist Eric Wolf's *Europe and the People without History* (1982), one of the first major texts to insist that societies and cultures outside the orbit of what came to be called "Europe" were equal partners in the making of modernity. Hämäläinen looks to Wolf's foundational historical work as a way to rethink "core and periphery" in world history, and emphasizes subsequent developments in indigenous history.

The April issue expanded our reviews section beyond historical monographs to include film reviews. In this issue, we continue to cast our review net widely, with three examinations of recent volumes in the U.S. State Department's *Foreign Relations of the United States* documents series. **Malcolm Byrne** (George Washington University) evaluates the retrospective volume on relations with Iran in 1952–1954, which attempts to rectify the 1989 version's failure to mention the 1953 U.S.-sponsored coup in Iran; **Kirsten Weld** (Harvard University) considers U.S. Central American policy during the Carter years; and **Nancy Mitchell** (North Carolina State University) looks at the volume on southern Africa during the same years.

The October issue will include a major roundtable on the history of antisemitism, and an article on the transatlantic legal implications of the 1957 Wolfenden Report on homosexuality that illustrates some of the striking methodological innovations of queer history. This issue will also take our review section into the public, with examinations of several sites of memory in the U.S. South, South Africa, and Eastern Europe.

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